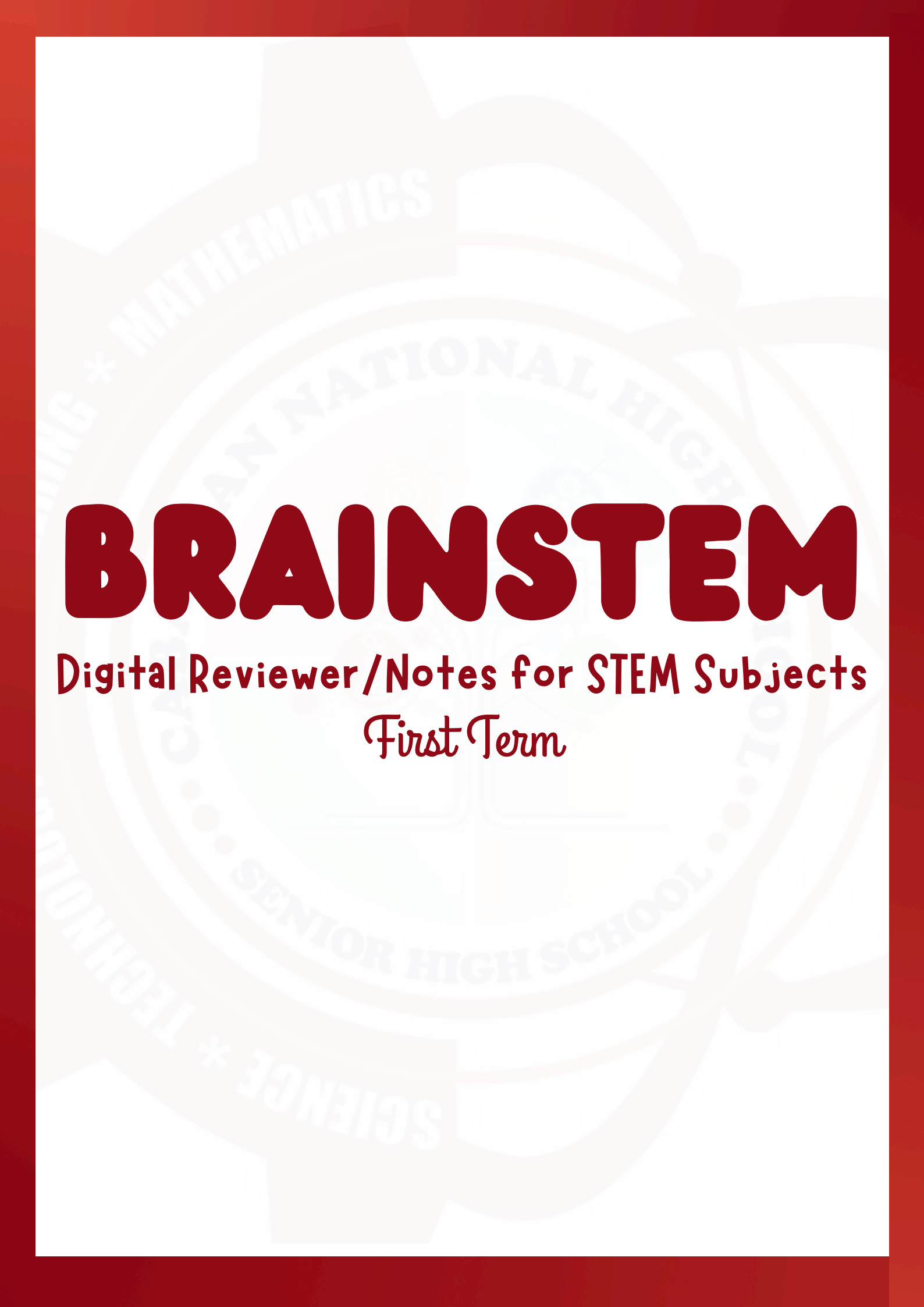




BRAINSTEM

Digital Reviewer/Notes for STEM Subjects
First Term

UNDERSTANDING CULTURE, SOCIETY AND POLITICS (UCSP)



Social Science

-branch of academic study that deals with human society and social relationships.
-helps us understand how people behave, interact, and organize themselves in communities, cultures, institutions and governments

Key Features of Social Science:

- Focuses on people and society
- Uses research and observation
- Aims to explain and sometimes solve social issues

Major Branches of Social Science:

Discipline	Focus
1. Anthropology	Human culture, origins, and traditions
2. Sociology	Social groups, behavior, and institutions
3. Political Science	Government, power, politics, and laws
4. Economics	Resources, production, and consumption
5. History	Past events and their impact on societies
6. Psychology	Human mind and behavior
7. Geography	People and their environment

1. Anthropology

- the study of humans, their origins, cultures, customs, and how they evolved over time. It looks at both ancient and modern societies to understand human behavior in its cultural context.

Focus: Culture, human evolution, traditions, language, rituals, and kinship.

Goal: To understand human diversity and the meaning behind cultural practices.

2. Sociology

- the study of society, social relationships, and how people interact in groups and institutions. It examines how individuals are influenced by social structures like family, education, religion and media.

Focus: Social norms, roles, classes, deviance, gender, education, inequality.

Goal: To analyze how society functions and how social behavior is shaped.

3. Political Science

- the study of politics, government systems, laws, and the distribution and use of power in society. It explores how decisions are made, how leaders are chosen, and how citizens participate in governance.

Focus: Government, elections, laws, public policy, political ideologies.

Goal: To understand political behavior and promote good governance and civic responsibility.

WHY IS IT IMPORTANT TO STUDY SOCIAL SCIENCE?

- To understand how society works
- To develop critical thinking and empathy
- To become active and informed citizens
- To help improve social policies and community life

UNDERSTANDING CULTURE, SOCIETY, AND POLITICS

- Culture is the way of living, on how to communicate to people and the different traditions.
- Culture is an important part of society—it includes the beliefs, values, traditions, language, customs, and way of life shared by a group of people

Different sociologists have differently defined the term culture

• Edward Tylor

—"culture is the complex whole which includes knowledge, belief, art, morals, laws, customs, and habits and any capabilities acquired by man as a member of society"

UNDERSTANDING CULTURE, SOCIETY AND POLITICS (UCSP)



• Linton

–“culture is social heredity, which is transmitted from one generation to another with the accumulation of individual experiences”

• John Beattie

–“culture is the way of life which is transmitted from generation to generation”

TYPES OF CULTURE

- **Material Culture** –anything that is tangible
- **Non-material Culture** –beliefs, knowledge, values
- **Real Culture** –exact happens in real life

CHARACTERISTICS

- From the definition it becomes clear that sociologically culture has specific meaning and characteristics. It is the product of human behavior and gaining knowledge through group. It is a system of learned behavior and set procedure.
- Culture is learned
- Culture is shared
- Culture is transmitted
- Culture is changing

TYPES OF SOCIAL NORM

Folkways

- are behaviors that are learned and shared by a social group that we often refer to as “customs” in a group that are not morally significant, but they can be important for social acceptance
- each group can develop different customs, but there can be customs that are embraced at a larger, societal level

Mores

- are norms of morality, or right or wrong, and if you break one it is often considered offensive to most people of a culture
- sometimes a more violation can also be illegal, but other times it can just be offensive. If more is not written down in legislation, it cannot get sanctioned by the criminal justice system. Other times it can be both illegal and morally wrong.

Taboo

- goes a step further and is a very negative norm that should not be violated because people will be upset
- additionally, one may get excluded from the group or society. The nature and the degree of the taboo are in the mores

Laws

- are social norms that have become formally inscribed at the state or national or even international level that can result in formal punishment for violations, such as fines, incarceration, or even death.
- are a form of social control that outlines rules, habits, and customs as a society uses to enforce conformity to its norms.

Introduction to Culture and Cultural Diversity

Culture

- shared beliefs, values, customs, behaviors
- passed from generation to generation

Elements of Culture

1. Symbols

- objects, signs, colors, or gestures that represent something important in a culture
- people in a culture understand and attach meaning to them
- ex.
Philippine Flag = patriotism
Cross = christianity
Heart Shape = love
Thumbs up = approval

2. Language

- the system of communication
- spoken, written or signed
- it allows people to express ideas, emotions, and pass down traditions

3. Norms

- Folkways- right vs rude
- Mores – right vs wrong

4. Values

- are shared ideas about what is good, important and desirable
- they guide how people live and what they consider right or wrong

5. Beliefs

- ideas or convictions that people accept as true, often passed from generation to generation
- they share how people understand the world

CULTURAL DIVERSITY

- existence of different cultural groups within a society
- ex: Philippines’ ethnic groups (Tagalog, Cebuano, Igorot, etc.)

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CULTURAL DIVERSITY

- promotes creativity and innovation
- enriches experiences
- builds tolerance

DIMENSIONS OF CULTURE (Hofstede's Model)

- keyways cultures around the world differ in how they think, act, and organize society
- a **framework** that explains how **cultures differ from one another** across countries or societies
- created by **Geert Hofstede**, a Dutch researcher, based on a large study of people working in global companies like IBM.
- it means that people from different cultures think, behave, and interact differently based on shared values.

They help answer questions like:

- Do people value **individual freedom** or **group loyalty** more?
- Do they tolerate **uncertainty**, or do they prefer clear rules?
- Is **power equally distributed**, or is hierarchy accepted?

WHY IS IT CALLED "DIMENSION"?

- It **measures** a cultural trait on a spectrum (high vs low).
- It allows for **comparison** between countries or societies.
- It provides a **framework** for analyzing culture.

These dimensions help us:

1. Understand why people act differently in various cultures
2. Work better with people from other countries
3. Avoid misunderstanding in school, work, and daily life

1. POWER DISTANCE INDEX (PDI)

- The degree to which less powerful members of a society accept and expect inequality in power.

High PDI:

- People accept hierarchy and authority without question.
- ex: In the Philippines or Malaysia, employees rarely challenge their boss.

Low PDI:

- Equality is valued; power is distributed more evenly.
- ex: In Denmark, students openly express their opinions to teachers.

2. INDIVIDUALISM VS COLLECTIVISM (IDV)

- The degree to which people prioritize individual goals versus group goals.

Individualism:

- Focus on personal freedom and achievements.
- ex: In the U.S., people often make decisions based on personal choice

Collectivism:

- Emphasis on loyalty, family, and group harmony.
- ex: In Japan or China, decisions consider the family or company's welfare.

3. MASCULINITY VS. FEMININITY (MAS)

- The preference in society for achievement and competition vs. care and quality of life.

Masculine Culture:

- Success, ambition, and competition are valued.
- ex: In Japan or Germany, work and achievement are central.

Feminine Culture:

- Emphasis on cooperation, modesty, and well-being.
- ex: In Sweden or the Netherlands, work-life balance is prioritized.

4. UNCERTAINTY AVOIDANCE INDEX (UAI)

- The extent to which people feel threatened by ambiguity or unknown situations.

High UAI:

- Preference for rules, structure, and certainty.
- ex: In Greece or France, people prefer detailed plans and dislike risk.

Low UAI:

- Comfort with uncertainty and flexibility.
- ex: In Singapore or the U.K., people are more open to change and innovation.

5. LONG-TERM VS SHORT-TERM ORIENTATION (LTO)

- The focus on future rewards versus respect for the past and present.

Long-Term Orientation:

- Values like perseverance, saving, and planning for the future.
- ex: In China or South Korea, education and hard work for long-term success are emphasized.

Short-Term Orientation:

- Focus on traditions, the "now," and quick results.
- ex: In the U.S. or the Philippines, people often seek immediate rewards or outcomes.

6. INDULGENCE VS. RESTRAINT (IVR)

- The extent to which people allow themselves to enjoy life and have fun.

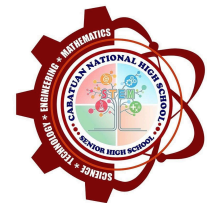
Indulgent Culture:

- Free expression of desire and leisure is valued.
- ex: In Mexico or Australia, people enjoy life, celebrations, and express emotions openly.

Restrained Culture:

- Suppression of desires, strict norms, and self-control.
- ex: In Russia or Egypt, people may feel less free to express themselves or seek fun.

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Dimensions of Culture (Hofstede's Model)

Dimension	Definition	High Score Culture	Low Score Culture
1. Power Distance (PDI)	Degree to which inequality and power differences are accepted in society	Philippines, Malaysia - People accept authority, hierarchy is respected	Denmark, Sweden - Power is shared, equality is valued
2. Individualism vs Collectivism (IDV)	Extent to which people act as individuals or as part of a group	USA, UK - independence and personal goals prioritized	China, Japan - Group loyalty and harmony emphasized
3. Masculinity vs Femininity (MAS)	Preference for achievement vs. care and quality of life	Japan, Germany - Success, competition, and achievement are valued	Sweden, Netherlands - Cooperation, modesty, and well-being are valued
4. Uncertainty Avoidance (UAI)	Degree to which people feel uncomfortable with uncertainty and ambiguity	France, Greece - Strong rules and need for structure	Singapore, UK - flexible, open to change and new ideas
5. Long-Term vs Short-Term Orientation (LTO)	Focus on future planning vs tradition and immediate results	China, South Korea - Future-oriented, values perseverance and savings	USA, Philippines - Present-focused, values quick results and tradition
3.6. Indulgence vs Restraint (IVR)	Extent to which people control their desires and impulses	Mexico, Australia - Leisure, fun, and free expression are encouraged	Russia, Egypt - Strict norms, self-control, and modesty are expected

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VIEWPOINTS / PERSPECTIVE ON CULTURE

1. CULTURAL RELATIVISM

- the belief that a culture should be understood based on its own values, beliefs, and practices rather than being judged by the standards of another culture.
- you try to understand **why** people practice it
- perspective of a particular culture
- right and wrong is culture specific
- opposite of universalism

2. ETHNOCENTRISM

- the belief that one's own culture is superior to others, leading people to judge other cultures using the standards of their own.
- **"our way is the best way"**

3. XENOCENTRISM

- the belief that another culture is superior to one's own culture
- **"other cultures are better than ours"**

4. CULTURE SHOCK

- the feeling of confusion, stress, or discomfort that people experience when they are exposed to a new and unfamiliar culture.
- feeling overwhelmed because everything around you is different

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SYMBOLS AND SYMBOLISM

SYMBOLS

- it is an object, word, or action that **stands for something else**, without natural relationship, that is culturally defined.

SYMBOLISM

- is when something **represents abstract ideas** or concepts.

TYPES OF SYMBOLS

1. Cultural Symbols

- objects, figures, sounds and colors
- facial expressions
- word interpretations
- gestures
- victory/peace sign
- Pearl of the Orient (Perlas ng Silangan)

Cultural Symbols of the Philippines

- | | |
|------------------|-------------------|
| Lupang Hinirang | Carabao |
| Philippine Eagle | Jose Rizal |
| Philippine Flag | Jeepney |
| Narra Tree | Palm/Coconut Tree |

Functions of Cultural Symbols

- are used to transfer culture, ideologies or beliefs from a group to another group of people, or from our elders to the next generations of people.

Cultural Practices in the Philippines

- Traditional Medical Practices - belief in "albularyo," herbal medicines, alternative medicines, and other home remedies.

Religious Symbols

- | | |
|--|--|
| Islam  | Buddhism  |
| Christianity  | Hinduism  |
| Judaism  | Sikhism  |
| Taoism  | |

- Religious** beliefs have many symbols within their doctrines and books.

Some Religious Practices in the Philippines

- Obando Festival in Bulacan for Fertility
- Panaad sa Camiguin as act of Penance and Pilgrim

Culinary Practices in the Philippines

- | | |
|------------|--------------|
| Adobo | Balut |
| Sinigang | Street Foods |
| Rice cakes | |

Child-rearing Practices in the Philippines

- Pagmamano
- Ninong/ninang
- Family Meal Time

2. Social Symbols

- Clothing and possessions
- Societal recognition
- Material possessions
- Family dynamics
- Gender roles
- social media use

Status Symbol

- is generally an object meant to signify the owner's high social and economic standing.

Common Color Symbols

- Red** - blood, war, passion, danger
- Purple** - royalty, nobility, luxury, authority
- Yellow** - caution, hazard, alarm, joy, sunshine, happiness
- Blue** - calm, stability, peace and trust
- Green** - life, nature, growth, balance, safety, money, permission (go)
- White** - purity, peace, new beginnings, and cleanliness
- Black** - evil, death, mourning, elegance, silence

3. Political Symbols and Practices

- it is related to the practices done in administration, distribution and attainment of power, bureaucratic composition, etc.

Political Symbols (Colors)



Political Symbols

- Executive - Enforces and carries out the laws
- Legislative - Makes and passes new laws.
- Judiciary - Interprets the laws and settles legal disputes.

Political Practices

- Political Dynasties
- Filipino Clans
- Celebrity Politicians
- Palakasan System
- Traditional Politicians (TRAPO)
- Catholic Church
- Power Revolts

4. Economic Symbols

- They represent economic standpoints which may be seen in various media such as Stock exchange, Money and Currency, Gold and Petroleum, Life Insurance, Banking, etc.

SIGNIFICANCE OF SYMBOLS AND SYMBOLISM

- Symbols have been a part of our lives and growth as human kind.
- The usage of symbols and symbolism has given mankind an avenue to **communicate** with the different group of people, **influence others** of different ideologies, and **observe values** that were transferred from generations to generations.

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CONTENT, PROCESSES AND CONSEQUENCES OF SOCIALIZATIONS

- the **preparation of newcomers** to become members of an existing group and to think, feel, and act in ways the group considers appropriate.
- viewed from the groups point of view
- a process of **member replacement**
- central process in a social life
- occurs through explicit instruction, conditioning and innovation and role modeling
- The socialization process **tends to be general rather than specific**, calls forth automatic behaviors and responses and persists through time.
- The family, peer groups, television, day care and school are today's basic agents of socialization.
- come to be seen more and more as the end-result that is, as **internalization**

EXAMPLES

- Widely diverse situations like child rearing, teaching someone a new game, orienting a new member of an organization.
- Preparing someone who has been in sales work to become a manager.

CONFLICT THEORISTS

- point out that these agents can be thought of as agents of domination because they may use their position to perpetuate an unequal power situation and to dominate the one being socialized.

AGENTS OF SOCIALIZATION

- a person, group, institution, or influence that **teaches individuals** the values, beliefs, behaviors, norms and skills needed to function in society.

1. Family

- language acquisition, relationships, rules, initial social interactions, morals, role models, behaviors

2. Peers

- activities trends

3. Religion

- values, love for others, meaning of life, guidelines on how to live

4. Government

- laws, sense of security, sanctions of punishment

5. Media

- stereotypes, trends, how to act

6. Work

- Employment, money, rules, roles

7. Ethnic Background

- beliefs, values, customs

8. Global/Social Groups

- social interactions, rules governing, activities

9. School

- grammar, rules, social setting values

STAGES OF SOCIALIZATION

A.

Pre-employment Stage

- outsider
- gathering information
- forming psychological contract

Encounter Stage

- newcomer
- testing experiences

Role Management

- insider
- changing roles and behaviors
- resolving conflicts

B.

Anticipatory

- prior to employment perspective employees **adhere to certain behavioral standards**

Formal

- occurs through formal training and active supervision

Informal

- occurs through interactions with "significant other" peers, managers, and even clients

C.

1. Oral Stage

- to establish **oral dependency**
- the child cries for everything as this is the only way it can communicate its needs

2. Anal Stage

- to **distinguish between wrong and right** actions through a system of reward and punishments
- undergoes toilet training, acquires other skills
- the child learns that one cannot totally depend on the mother for everything

3. Oedipal Stage

- identify itself** with the social role ascribed to it on basis of its sex
- the child becomes a member of the family as a whole

4. Latency Stage

- learn to be independent** in the daily routine at home
- learns social norms
- This stage has been called 'gang stage' by some sociologists.
- group **loyalties** are considered important

5. Adolescence Stage

- onset of **puberty** and continues through the teenage years
- transition from childhood to maturity during which new patterns of behavior are learned

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TYPES OF SOCIALIZATION

1. Primary Socialization

- takes place in **infancy** and childhood
- most crucial stage of socialization

2. Secondary Socialization

- starts from the latter stage of childhood and goes up to maturity.

3. Development Socialization

- As an individual grows he **changes and molds himself** according to the standard and the needs of the society.

4. Anticipatory Socialization

- makes the **individual expect** his or her own participation in a social situation by watching how others would behave in that situation

5. Resocialization

- **process of learning a new** and different set of attitudes, values and behaviors from those in one's previous background

DEVIANCE

- when a person learns and acts on behaviors that break group rules

CONFORMITY

- when a person alters their behavior or beliefs to align with social standards
- group acceptance

ENCULTURATION

- learning your **first culture**
- lifelong process by which an individual learns the traditional content of a culture and assimilates its practices and values

ACCULTURATION

- adapting to a **second culture**
- happens when an individual or group from one culture comes into continuous, direct contact with a different culture.

EXTERNALIZATION

- you are the one **who teach** what has been taught to you

INTERNALIZATION

- what has been **taught to you**

CONCEPTS OF SOCIAL GROUPS AND SOCIAL ORGANIZATION

Coming together is a beginning, staying together is a progress and working together is success.

—Henry Ford

GROUP

- **collection of two or more persons** who are in social interactions, who are guided by similar norms, values and expectations, and who maintain a stable pattern of relations over a period of time (**G. Homans, 1950**)
- set individuals who **identify and interact** with one another in a structured way based on shared values and goals. (**D. Light, 1984**)
- any collection of people who interact on the **basis of shared expectations** regarding one another's behavior (**Kornblum, 2003**)
- consists of two or more people who are bonded together in relatively stable patterns of social interaction and who share a feeling of unity. (**Hughes and Kroeher, 2009**)
- specified number of individuals where each recognizes members from non-members.
- collection of individuals characterized by:
 - a. Communication
 - b. Recognition
 - c. Specialized Roles

THREE REQUIREMENTS FOR A GROUP

- There must be two or more people.
- There must be interaction.
- the members must be together physically.

FACTORS THAT INFLUENCE GROUPS

1. Motivational base shared by individuals (based on needs, interests, desires, noble activities, insecurities, or problems).
2. Size of the group
3. Type of group goals
4. The kind of a group cohesion/unity (the capability to function and interact collectively in the direction of their goals).

GENERAL CHARACTERISTICS OF A GROUP

1. A group has identifiable members and outsiders.
2. A group has a social structure in the sense that each part or member has a position related to other positions.
3. Each member in a group has roles to play.
4. There is mutual reciprocity among members in a group.

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OTHER COLLECTIONS

(but are not considered as social groups)

Aggregate

- or a crowding group of people in the **same location at the same time** but do not share a sense of identity nor interact with each other.

Category

- some individuals who **share similar characteristics** but is not, in any way, connected to one another.

Collectively

- collection of people in each place and time (e.g. crowds, masses, public and social movements also considered as temporary groups)

Social Group

- a unit of **interacting personalities with interdependence of roles and statuses** existing between and among themselves
- a collection of people who interact with each other in **accordance with the position** they occupy in the society

Social Relation

- when an interaction **persists often enough**, a social relation is formed
- is **reciprocal in nature**; the behavior of the interactors derives its meaning from his relation to the other person or persons involved.

Social Organization

- refers to a type of collectively established for the pursuit of the specific aims or goals, characterized by a formal structure of rules, authority relations, a division of labor and limited membership or admission. (J. Daymond, 1995)

2 TYPES OF SOCIAL ORGANIZATION

FORMAL

- with constitution / set of by-laws
- formed to serve a specific goal or purpose
- division of labor, set of rules/policies, system of replacing/inducting members

INFORMAL

- serve the needs of individual members without a well-defined purpose
- arises spontaneously
- unplanned

CONSEQUENCES OF GROUP BOUNDARIES

- a. people gain a clearer sense of their diversity
- b. ethnocentrism may grow
- c. serious personal and social problems may arise

3 TYPES OF FORMAL ORGANIZATION

Utilitarian

- provide **income, a means of livelihood** or other type of benefits to its members

Normative

- pursue **moral goals and commitments**
- Religious Organization/Educational Organization

Coercive

- uses force to **maintain control**
- Political Organization/ Government

GROUPS ACCORDING TO SOCIAL TIES

Primary Groups

- a small group that **shares close, personal, enduring relationship**; a fundamental unit of human society
- characterized by love, affection, care, support, concern, etc.
- family, close friends

Secondary Groups

- characterized by impersonal, business-like and goal-oriented relationships
- mostly temporary
- **weak emotional ties**: little personal knowledge
- employees, workmates, business associates

GROUPS ACCORDING TO SELF-IDENTIFICATION

In-Groups

- a group where an individual feel like he or she **belongs to**
- a social unit in which individuals feel at home and with which they identify

Out Groups

- Groups an individual does **not identify with due to difference** such as status, social class, interests, beliefs, etc.
- some other individuals **feel opposition or desire to complete** to out-groups.

GROUPS ACCORDING TO PURPOSE

Special Interest Group

- organized to **meet the special interest** of the members
- handicrafts, painting/arts, music

Task Group

- group **assigned** to accomplish jobs which cannot be done by one person

Influence/Peer Group

- groups **organized** to support or influence social actions

GROUPS ACCORDING TO LOCATION OR QUALITY OF RELATIONSHIP

Gemeinschaft

- "community"
- refers to individuals bound together by common norms
- shared physical space and shared beliefs

Gesellschaft

- "society"
- refers to associations in which self-interest is the primary justification for membership

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REFERENCE GROUP

- we **do not necessarily know personally**
- source of standards and identity
- there can be some overlap between reference groups and primary or secondary groups

LEADERSHIP

- it is reflected in the actions, values, and influence we have on others.

TYPES OF LEADERSHIP

Servant Leadership

- A leader who **puts the needs of others first**, serves with humility, and helps people grow and succeed.

Democratic Leadership

- A leader who **values teamwork**, encourages participation, and considers everyone's ideas before making decisions.

Transformational Leadership

- A leader who **inspires and motivates** others to improve, embrace change, and achieve a shared vision.

Situational Leadership

- A leader who **adjusts** their leadership style **depending on the situation** and the needs of the people they are leading.

Autocratic Leadership

- A leader who **makes decisions independently** and provides clear instructions, especially when quick action is needed.

Laissez-faire Leadership

- A leader who **gives team members the freedom to make decisions** and work independently, while providing guidance when necessary.

KINSHIP

- refers to the **social relationships** that connect people through blood (consanguinity), marriage (affinity), or adoption/fictive ties.
- It is one of the **most important social institutions** because it influences our identity, responsibilities, inheritance, support system, and sense of belonging.

TYPES OF KINSHIP

Consanguinity (Blood Relations)

- These are family members **related by blood**, such as your parents, siblings, grandparents, aunts, uncles, and cousins.

Affinity (Relations by Marriage)

- These are relatives gained **through marriage**, such as your mother-in-law, father-in-law, brother-in-law, sister-in-law, and step-relatives.

Fictive or Legal Kinship

- These are relationships that are socially or legally recognized as family even **without blood or marriage**.
- Example: adopted family, ninong or ninang

Kinship is more than knowing who your relatives are, it also reflects the roles, responsibilities, traditions, and values that are passed down from one generation to another.

STATE INSTITUTIONS

- organizations that are **created and operated by the government**.
- They have the **authority** to make and enforce laws, maintain peace and order, and provide public services.
- Examples: Department of Education (DepEd), Philippine National Police (PNP), Local Government Units (LGUs), Department of Health (DOH), Courts and Congress

MAIN ROLE

- Implement laws
- Protect citizens
- Provide public services
- Promote peace, order, and development

NON-STATE INSTITUTIONS

- organizations **not directly controlled by the government**.
- They are **established by private** individuals, groups, or communities to serve different purposes.
- Examples: Family Schools (private), Religious organizations, Businesses and corporations
- **Non-Governmental Organizations (NGOs):** Media organizations Youth organizations

MAIN ROLE

- Promote community welfare
- Provide education and employment
- Advocate for social issues
- Offer humanitarian services
- Influence public opinion

KEY DIFFERENCE

State Institutions

- Government-created
- Exercise legal authority
- Funded mainly by public funds
- Serve the entire nation

Non-State Institutions

- Privately or community organized
- No direct governmental authority
- Funded through private resources, donations, or income
- Serve specific groups or communities.